The Apprentice, The Garnet, Cold Edge

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/43996636.

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Teen And Up Audiences

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Additional Tags:
Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner's A+ Parenting, Angst, Hurt No Comfort, Being a dead girl is hard, It's hard and not even Adora understands, Past Child Abuse, Alternate Universe - Canon Divergence, Weird Runestone headcanons, Drabble, Memory Loss, Narrative fun with tenses, No editors we die with courage, Adora's self worth issues only got worse when she was murdered

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by genVicron

Summary

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The Garnet would rather burn than disappoint.

Shadow Weaver lost her Apprentice years ago; her own fault, really, she expected results from only half the equation. Truly a shame she had needed to take the child apart to learn of her Apprentice's missing piece.

Sometimes she can almost remember her name. But the screaming. It never stops.

She knows she has one. So hard to think. Garnet howls. Crackling outrage. Burning grief. So loud. So **loud.** It never stops.

Oh well, she had tucked what she could away into the Black Garnet, made what remained of the Apprentice useful in some way.

Mistress channels it. Mistress focuses it. Communes with her. Lets her feel something else.

A demonstration of her new strength- of the Garnet's submission to her at last- soothed Hordak's irritation regarding a lost Force Captain applicant. He didn't ask questions, she knew as well as he that he would not care what lines she crossed to take power in her hands.

Mistress' touch freezes. Bites like knives. Like her insides burning out. Over, and over, and she **doesn't know why she**

remembers what that feels like.

Still better than grief. Better than failure.

And her Apprentice has been so useful as the Garnet. If Shadow Weaver had known a buffer soul would let her unlock her Runestone's potential, she would have fed it the Scorpion Queen to begin with.

Her Apprentice's life was a simple price to pay for having missed that chance.

Mistress used to call her useless, she thinks. When she can think. When the cold Edge beyond the burning Garnet watches Mistress commune.

Once it had been mere rumor that all shadows of the Fright Zone were her eyes. Now, with Shadow Weaver's realized mastery over the Garnet, the truth of that rumor could become quite spectacularly literal.

Grizzlor was returning, the Dark Ones' silent gaze prickling on his back. Shadow Weaver allowed herself a smile as he entered her domain.

He had failed her. He knew better than that.

She remembers failed rituals. Silent spells. Useless. Waste of power, of potential.

It hurts. *"The world always hurts, my Apprentice. And it is through that pain, through sacrifice, that we grow. Do you require another demonstration?"* No! No she doesn't. She'll be better! She'll be useful! Please!

Being useful is better. Freezing bite is better. Being Mistress' Garnet is better.

He cowered as she swept toward him through the dark. He knew full well the kind of lesson she could teach him, if his failure was severe enough.

How many times does she have to teach her Apprentice this lesson? How many times must Mistress make her **watch** before she learns to apply herself?

"Don't look! Please!" Orange eye. Blue eye. Failure hurts them. Her? It has to be them, right? Mistress' eyes are the same colour. Fractured. Still the same. Two people punished for the Apprentice's failure, for the Garnet's defiance.

He stammered and choked through his report.

Blue eye, orange eye. Mistress' newest target has the Edge’s attention. Pushing, calling up the eyes. Why can she only remember one of each?

There was little of interest to it, the Whispering Woods conjured a beast to halt his advance.

She knows those eyes, knows the shape of wounds still pulsing with wild, untamed magic beneath the bandages wrapped about his shoulder.

It was too fast, he couldn't rally the troops in time. She did not care, such creatures were fickle things. Shadow Weaver could try again in a season and it would move on in the meantime.

He hadn't even had the decency to stand close to it long enough to make himself a proper snack for her servants. Perhaps…

She knows her, the name just out of reach, so much closer than her own.

He described a terrible monster, fur, fangs and bulk that the thin lines along his jaw didn't seem to agree with. If he was going to exaggerate, Shadow Weaver could watch his men for a real answer.

The cold doesn't bite, the Edge slips between her and Mistress' touch. She expands, at Mistress' command, and enough of the Edge has been brought near that she can think through it again.

She hears dozens of voices. She knows the claws, the mane, even the teeth they whisper about. "She had a jacket," one of them murmurs, and she strains to know more, "mismatched eyes, a magicat in red," breathe more, and she **knows.**

Catra.

"I'm sorry," she's looking up into those brilliant eyes. And why has she never told her how beautiful they are?

Catra, Catra, **Catra.**

A magicat, lost to the Whispering Woods, not even a proper beast. Shadow Weaver would laugh at him if he was worth the time. If that was the case she would be able to send another battalion within the week. Those led astray by the Woods burned bright, but did not last long.

Catra has it, the Edge whispers, the other half. The Sword.

"Don't talk, please," Catra's eyes shimmer, she's crying, don't cry. *"Hang on."* The Apprentice isn't worth crying over.

He's leaving. No, he can't leave.

"Looks like I can't…" it's falling away, she's failing her, *"keep our promise."*

He has to stay, the Sword needs him to stay, the echo in his wounds makes it stop hurting. **Catra makes it stop hurting.**

Shadow Weaver watched him turn, amusement curling the darkness around her at how his shoulders sagged with relief.

Red flashed past her head, the boom of lightning and a woman's roar.

Grizzlor howled in terror as it locked around his body, leaving Weaver barely a moment to step aside as he was dragged deeper into her sanctum and pinned against the Black Garnet. How curious.

She approached, ignoring his panicked whimpering, to behold what new wonders her Garnet had in store for her. Perhaps a single soul had not been enough.

Power flashed within, flickering faster and faster until she could see it, just beneath the surface, hand extended out and wrapped

around Grizzlor's torso, the figure of Shadow Weaver's Garnet.

"Sword…" the figure rasped out, the Garnet's face sharper, more defined, than it had been in years. "She has… the Sword."

She knows her name.

Catra's fading voice is crying it, the Sword is calling it. *" **Adora!** "*

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